



How do you see the Tata group's acquisition of Air India impacting market dynamics and your own operations?

Vistara continues to operate as an independent entity and both our parent companies, the Tata group and Singapore Airlines, remain invested in our growth and expansion plans. We are committed to our long-term vision of becoming one of the best airlines in the world.



Since Vistara emerged from the Singapore Airlines school, doesn't that make you old school?

These days, there is no old and new school. It's all one big school with aviation morphing into this situation. There are two different business models to a certain extent, which are low-cost and full-service. If you look at our product proposition and what we offer today, there is a group of people or a set of people who value add-ons more than what a normal low-cost carrier provides. That is the reason why we even introduced a premium economy, which is quite common in other countries. We thought that it is something that would also resonate here. Especially in Covid-19 times, there are people who want a little bit more privacy as compared to an economy class product. What we have seen is that the occupancy in the front end, whether it's business

or premium economy, did actually see a slight boost as compared to what you would expect otherwise. Usually, business class and premium economy seats are occupied by business travellers. But just after we restarted flights, we saw a lot of families also travelling in them because they felt those seats provided a cocoon and a safe experience.



Did the success of premium economy surprise you?

No, I wouldn't say it was a surprise. We did know

if you look at the popular metro routes like Delhi-Mumbai, Delhi-Bengaluru or Mumbai-Bengaluru, there is enough potential for us to fill the premium economy and business [class] seats.



With India lifting the embargo on scheduled international operations, what kind of growth are you looking at deriving from international flights in the new fiscal?

International expansion is one of the most important aspects of our long-term

were already part of our expansion plans but also made inroads into new geographies, paving the way for a strong foothold for the brand in global aviation. We strongly feel that there is great potential for long-haul direct flights from India, with travellers increasingly displaying a strong preference for non-stop travel, and we are uniquely positioned to cater to this growing demand, especially as more wide-body aircraft are expected to join our fleet soon. The resumption of scheduled international operations is expected to

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[that] there was a market for this particular product. Again, it also depends on the route. If you look at the other big carriers in India, for example IndiGo or SpiceJet, they do fly to a lot of secondary and tertiary cities where we don't have as much of a big demand to deploy premium economy or business, which is the reason why we also have some all-economy aircraft flying on some of those routes. But

growth strategy. Despite the challenges of the pandemic, we managed to introduce our services to seven new international destinations under air bubble agreements, including London Heathrow, Dhaka, Doha, Frankfurt, Sharjah, Malé and Paris, besides resuming operations to Dubai, Singapore, Kathmandu and Colombo. These operations not only helped us to introduce Vistara in markets that

stimulate demand. However, a lot would depend on the country-specific travel requirements. We are evaluating all options and working on additional flights.



To what extent did the pandemic affect your expansion plans?

In 2018-19, we had placed an order for about 56 aircraft, including Airbus 320 Neos, Boeing 787s and